

CYRIL ZIMA

DIRECTOR / AI FILMMAKER

Los Angeles, CA
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PROFILE: Los Angeles-based Director and Screenwriter working across traditional narrative and character-driven generative filmmaking. Over a decade of directing experience spanning narrative films, commercial production, and digital media, with directed short-form work generating more than 200 million views online. Directs both live-action and AI video productions, combining cinematic staging and viral storytelling mechanics with cutting-edge generative AI workflows, character consistency, and digital persona direction.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI FILMMAKER / AI VISUAL ARTIST

Self-employed · Los Angeles, CA · Mar 2023 – Present

- Direct AI-driven films, music videos, cinematic visuals, virtual artists, and character-based content from concept through final delivery.
- Architect end-to-end AI video pipelines: multi-view prompting, face-locking, character consistency across dynamic scene cuts, and inpainting workflows.
- Direct digital personas and virtual companions focusing on emotional performance, facial micro-expressions, lip-sync accuracy, and cinematic camera blocking.
- Combine multimodal generative AI tools (video, image, voice, music, LLMs) with traditional cinematography, editing, and pacing mechanics.

FILM DIRECTOR / WRITER

Self-employed · Los Angeles, CA · Sep 2011 – Present

- Directed and developed narrative films, commercials, and digital shorts, generating over 200 million views across directed online work.
- Authored three feature-length screenplays and original TV pilots; combining traditional filmmaking with generative AI for visual development.
- Led multidisciplinary crews, talent casting, on-set actor direction, camera blocking, and post-production delivery under tight deadlines.

NEFFT STUDIO

Producer / Director / Head of Production · Moscow · 2011 – 2015

- Managed end-to-end commercial studio operations; directed and produced 40+ commercials and 3 television documentary films.
- Oversaw creative treatments, client relationships, budget allocation, and delivery for major advertising and broadcast campaigns.

TOOLS & SOFTWARE

Veo · Omni Flash · Higgsfield · Kling · Sora · Seedance · HeyGen · GPT · Gemini · Claude · Grok · Midjourney · Meshy · Suno · DaVinci Resolve · Adobe Creative Cloud · Final Cut Pro · Photoshop · Illustrator · Final Draft

SELECTED FILMOGRAPHY

TICKLY TIK (2022)

Director · Horror / Short Film

HOT SET (2017)

Writer / Director · Short Film

[15M views on YouTube](#)

OUTBREAK (2017)

Director / Editor · Drama / Short Film

MOLEHILL (2017)

Director / Editor · Comedy, Drama / Short Film

OCEAN (2016)

Writer / Director · Short Narrative Film

[37M views on YouTube](#) · [149M views for scene trailer](#)

CHARON (2016)

Director / Writer / Editor · Sci-Fi, Thriller / Short Film

SUKA (2014)

Writer / Director · Short Narrative Film

[4M views on YouTube](#) · [50M+ views on Facebook](#)

CORE SKILLS

Directing (Live-Action & AI) · Virtual Personas & Character Consistency · Lip-Sync & Performance Tuning · Generative Video Pipelines · Visual Storytelling · Cinematography & Lighting · Editing & Color Grading · Audience Retention Mechanics

EDUCATION

NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY

MA, Film & Media Production · 2015 – 2016

RUSSIAN ACADEMY OF EDUCATION

MA, Journalism & PR · 2011 – 2013

PEOPLES' FRIENDSHIP UNIVERSITY OF RUSSIA

BA, Journalism · 2000 – 2004